

tomography/CT imaging. Hopefully, the next editions of these textbooks will address this evolving area within the field of nuclear medicine.

Overall, *Nuclear Medicine* is an excellent, comprehensive, and authoritative nuclear medicine reference. Over the years, the first edition became my personal favorite reference text. This second edition, along with Sandler et al's *Diagnostic Nuclear Medicine*, will form a solid foundation for any nuclear medicine reference library. *Nuclear Medicine* is highly recommended for practicing clinicians in the specialty.

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1. Bianco JA, reviewer. *JAMA*. 2005;293:1267. Review of: Ell PJ, Gambhir SS, eds. *Nuclear Medicine in Clinical Diagnosis and Treatment*, vols 1 & 2.

HENRY'S CLINICAL DIAGNOSIS AND MANAGEMENT BY LABORATORY METHODS

Edited by Richard A. McPherson and Matthew R. Pincus,
21st ed, 1450 pp, \$129.
Philadelphia, Pa, Saunders Elsevier, 2007.
ISBN-13 978-1-4160-0287-1.

ABOUT 6 YEARS AGO, JOHN BERNARD HENRY, MD, PUBLISHED the 20th edition of *Clinical Diagnosis*. Between 1969 and 2001, Dr Henry edited or coedited the 14th through 20th editions of this classic laboratory medicine text, making it one of the most successful medical books. In 2007, the text will enter its 99th year of publication, as well as mark its fourth transition of chief editor, from Henry to Drs McPherson and Pincus, previously associate editors. The new editors added Henry's name to the title, formalizing the common practice of referring to the book as "Henry's." *Clinical Diagnosis* has been and remains the main reference text for the field of clinical pathology.

It would not have been surprising if major changes in the content or organization of *Clinical Diagnosis* were to occur after Henry's departure. More dramatic changes, however, were made in the last revision under his leadership, and the changes in this edition are more evolutionary than revolutionary. Most of the authors are known for expertise in their subfields and wrote for the previous edition. New chapters on the laboratory role in bioterrorism and the clinical pathology of cancer are included. Most notably, changes have improved the flow of topics between chapters and the content of the newer chapters fills gaps in the previous edition. The content of the material introduced in the last edition appears to be more relevant for a textbook. For example, topics on automation and informatics in "The Clinical Laboratory" section have changed so that they are

more applicable and less time sensitive. Another example is how the editors have improved the coverage of molecular pathology chapters and made them more relevant to clinical diagnosis. The Molecular Pathology section has changed little as compared with the 20th edition, but new chapters on clinical pathology of cancer and flow cytometry have been added.

Almost certainly, the editors struggled with page counts as they considered new topics, a significant problem in any technology field. Eliminating old material is challenging, since it often serves as the foundation for newer topics. Expanding the page count and splitting the book into 2 volumes have added undesirable expense and bulk. Although the size remains about the same as that of the previous edition, the increase in material is immediately obvious and is confirmed by the addition of 8 new chapters. Unfortunately, the editors sacrificed readability by using an 8- or 9-point font and pages with narrow margins. On the plus side, color is used throughout the book, rather than concentrated on a few pages with color plates. This allows many more color diagrams and charts than the previous edition and photomicrographs are conveniently located next to the explanatory text.

Traditionally, *Clinical Diagnosis* has competed with *Tietz's Textbook of Clinical Chemistry and Molecular Diagnostics*, by Burtis, Ashwood, and Burns (2006) and with *Clinical Chemistry: Theory, Analysis, Correlation* by Kaplan, Pesce, and Kazmierczak (2003). Both texts focus on clinical chemistry rather than the general domain of clinical laboratory medicine. Since 2001, several new texts covering aspects of clinical pathology have emerged. These include *Laboratory Medicine: Clinical Pathology in the Practice of Medicine*, edited by Laposata (2002), and the more comprehensive *Clinical Laboratory Medicine*, edited by McClatchey (2002). Of the 2, McClatchey's book covers clinical pathology in a manner similar to that of *Clinical Diagnosis*, but plans for the next edition are pending as editors undergo transition. For what it is worth, Amazon lists *Clinical Diagnosis* as the most popular of these 4 texts.

In my opinion, *Clinical Diagnosis* continues to be the best reference for clinical pathology. I strongly recommend it to those studying clinical pathology, as well as those interested in various aspects of interpreting laboratory tests as they apply to clinical care. I especially recommend that those owning *Clinical Diagnosis* older than the 20th edition should purchase this edition, since it is much improved and contains new material. Few textbooks have been published as long as *Clinical Diagnosis*. This edition ensures that it will continue into a second century of publication.

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